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Do Learning Styles Affect the Way We Learn?

There are many different ways people best interpret information. Some master subjects from visualizing slides, some by listening to a lecture. Others have to feel what they are doing, and hold it in their hands to understand it. Regardless of what method, whatever medium it may be, I believe learning styles greatly affect how well we are able to learn.

Out of the three main categories, I am a visual learner. I have to see things to understand them, like making flash cards for vocabulary, watching tutorials rather than reading articles, and drawing out diagrams in my notes. Text or audio without pictured examples simply doesn't work for me. I get lost, frustrated, and at the end of it all, wind up scouring the internet for any image or video example I can find.

In the wrong style, tasks quickly become confusing. If you can't do something the way your brain is wired to, words start sounding like made-up gibberish, and your senses get completely overwhelmed with unreadable information, which is why I believe learning styles are so key to how well people can learn. For example, when I tried to step out of my comfort zone, helping my father fix our toilet by working hands on with him immediately before seeing a visual example, everything crumbled. We bought the wrong parts, I kept using tools in the wrong places, and the project took us days until we finally caved and found a tutorial video.

Some argue that styles are meaningless. The article presented in this week's material proposes that even when students know their learning style, they don't use methods that align

with it, and therefore, their learning styles have no effect on them at all, but I completely disagree. Learning styles, in fact, very greatly matter to academic and general success, and trying to force someone to learn outside their style can have serious consequences on their ability to properly master a topic.